

Contemporaneous meeting notes for use with other resources in preparation of draft minutes
MEMBERS – PERSONS appearing – BRIEF DESCRIPTION – DECISIONS. RSA 91-A:2.

The Claremont City Council held a meeting on Wednesday, February 26, 2024, in the Council Chambers of City Hall.

The meeting was called to order by Mayor Girard at 6:30 p.m.

Members of the Council present:

Ward I Councilor Andrew O’Hearne
Ward II Councilor Brian Zutter
Ward III Councilor Jonathan Hayden
Assistant Mayor Debora Matteau
At-Large Councilor William Greenrose
At-Large Councilor Wayne Hemingway
At-Large Councilor William Limoges
At-Large Councilor Nicholas Koloski
Mayor Dale Girard

Also present:

Yoshi Manale, City Manager

AGENDA CHANGES

None.

REPORT OF THE SECRETARY

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Assistant Mayor Matteau to accept the minutes of the January 22nd, 2024, City Council meeting.

Voice vote:

**Koloski – yes
Greenrose – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes**

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Motion carried 9-0

MAYOR'S NOTES

Mayor Girard read a retirement proclamation for City employee, Pam Dyer.

This past Monday Mayor Girard had a meeting with other Mayors throughout the state and wants to make people aware of the following:

The City to the north of us they have done a resolution amongst their Council expressing their concern of the freezing of federal grants programs to the states and municipalities.

Senate Bill 113 is currently tabled in the Senate, trying to add twelve million dollars into all local municipalities to assist with welfare costs.

DES will hold a meeting at the Claremont Opera House for their Acuity application on Thursday March 6th at 6:00 p.m.

Mayor Girard clarified the Claremont Court will not be closing.

Parks and Recreation will hold their Pigskin 5k on Sunday March 9th.

CITY MANAGER'S REPORT

Manager Manale updated the public on Department of Public Works and added recognition to staff.

There will be a notice that goes out with the next water bill, that on January 26th there was a water break which increased water turbidity for several hours, this is a requirement to let the public know but the water was and is still safe.

Councilor Koloski asked for an update on the Opera House balcony, Manager Manale will look into this and provide an update.

Councilor Koloski asked about street light issues, and who it gets reported to.

Manager Manale noted needing the pole number then it would get reported to DPW, then DPW can report to Eversource.

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Councilor Hemingway shared concern over several properties that are in arrears for taxes and would like a status on tax deeded properties.

CITIZEN'S FORUM

Mayor Girard gave reminder that Citizen's forum is designed to allow you the opportunity to make the Council aware of your concerns. Please state your name and ward number, we ask you to address your concerns directly to the Council. The Council Manager will not be responding to you during this time. You are limited to five minutes on any non-agenda items. In the back of the room please write down your contact information if you'd like to be contacted as well as your concern on the clipboard for follow up.

Cornelia Sargent, Ward II, thanked the Mayor and City Councilors, and reminded everyone there is a public hearing from DES at 6:00 p.m. in the Opera House next Thursday, and stated Acuity is proposing a change of use, which is prohibited under our City Code. This is a major change of use from a small recycling center to a regional waste transfer business. DES permits do not take effect until all federal, state, and local permits are received under rule 305.04B. Ms. Sargent urges all to protect our community and our zoning board to defend our roads, bridges, taxes, property values, health, welfare, and children. Please stand up for Claremont we have the power of NO.

James Contois, Ward II, noted Acuity wants to build a construction and demolition waste facility on a 70 ft wide area with 77 trucks per day and with over 312 million pounds of C&D Waste every year. The meeting is next Thursday at 6:00 p.m., and the people of Claremont do not want this here.

Jack Hurley, Ward II, supports the last two speakers. At the last meeting an application was considered for Meg Hurley and according to website there are two available seats, and no alternates. Mr. Hurley shared concern that the reasons for decision were not public. Mr. Hurley stated Meg is a very highly qualified person who applied and was denied, it's important for the residents of Claremont know that these decisions or reasons are not always made public.

NEW BUSINESS

Broadband Expansion Update Presentation

Monica Thibault and Bryan Christiansen from Comcast government affairs presented the BMGI, and a lunch and learn program.

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ABOUT COMCAST

We have consistent and strong financial results which allow us to constantly innovate and invest

As of Q4 2021...

1983 Year Founded	Largest Converged IP Network in the US	\$4.2 Billion Comcast's investment in 2021 to strengthen, expand, and evolve the network in the United States
Philadelphia Headquarters	32 Million Comcast Cable Customer Relationships Across the United States	\$1 Billion Our commitment to invest in Digital Equity over the next decade
Manchester, NH Divisional Office	63 Million Homes and businesses passed in the United States	189,000 Employees
#26 Fortune 500 Rank		

COMCAST

New Hampshire Broadband Matching Grant Initiative (BMGI)

Establish by RSA 12-O:61-63

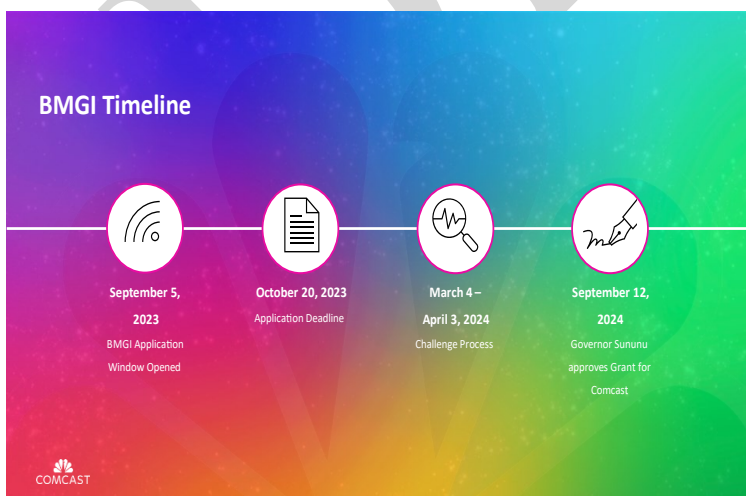
Designed to fund infrastructure projects that deliver high speed internet (100/100 Mbps) to unserved or underserved locations

State match of 75% of eligible projects

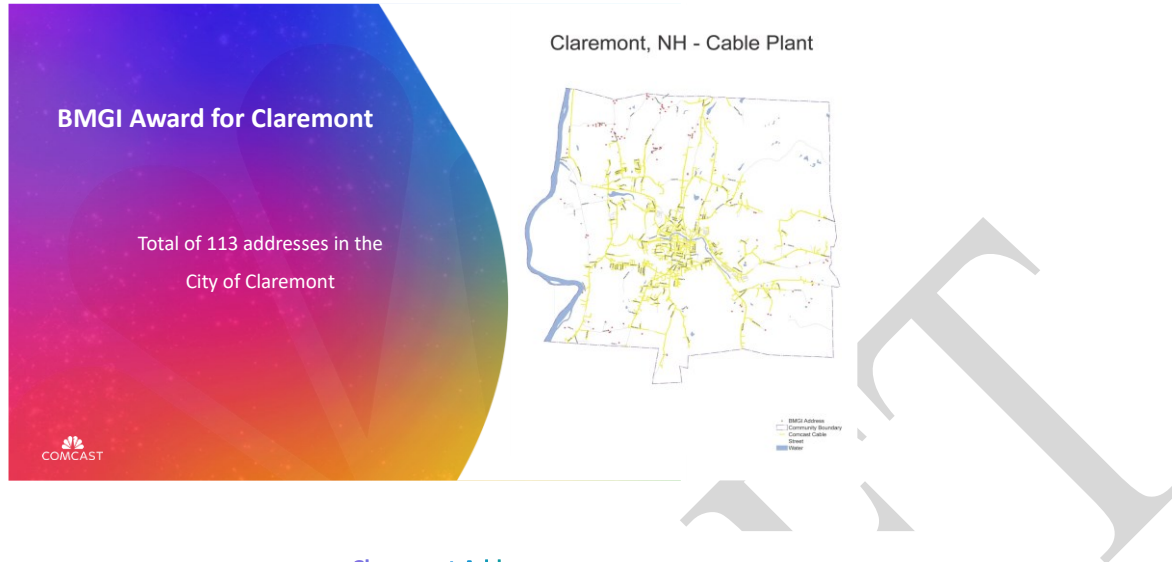
*Source: <https://www.nheconomy.com/office/broadband-initiatives/cpi/broadbandmatching-grants-initiative>

COMCAST

~\$24mil	BEA awarded a total of almost \$24M for 12 projects by 3 ISPs
~3.5mil	Comcast was awarded more than \$3.5M
592	Comcast will bring service to 592 unserved or underserved addresses



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Claremont Addresses

149 ALDEN RD
164 ALDEN RD
78 BALCOM PL
456 BIBLE HILL RD
32 CAAJUM RD
213 CASE HILL RD
343 CASE HILL RD
41 CAT HOLE RD
405 CHESTNUT ST
407 CHESTNUT ST
409 CHESTNUT ST
443 CHESTNUT ST
100 CRAIGUE HILL RD
353 E GREEN MOUNTAIN RD
342 ELM ST
542 ELM ST
547 ELM ST
554 ELM ST
577 ELM ST
598 ELM ST
617 ELM ST

26 FERRY LANDING RD
19 FIELDING PL
211 FOISY HILL RD
229 FOISY HILL RD
8 FONTAINE RD
13 FONTAINE RD
8 GOSS ST
21 GRISSOM LN
103 GRISSOM LN
108 GRISSOM LN
113 GRISSOM LN
118 GRISSOM LN
145 GRISSOM LN
211 GRISSOM LN
380 HANOVER ST
18 HEWITT RD
27 HEWITT RD
40 HEWITT RD
43 HEWITT RD
86 HEWITT RD
281 HEWITT RD

295 HEWITT RD
305 HEWITT RD
51 HOMESTEAD PL
134 HOMESTEAD PL
64 IRONWOOD HILL RD
85 IRONWOOD HILL RD
13 IVES PL
17 IVES PL
29 IVES PL
31 IVES PL
365 JARVIS HILL RD
443 JARVIS HILL RD
447 JARVIS HILL RD
473 JARVIS HILL RD
100 LADEAU RD
100 LYNCH PL
112 MAXFIELD PARISH HWY
150 MAXFIELD PARISH HWY
4 OLD COACH RD
14 OLD COACH RD
19 OLD COACH RD

COMCAST

Claremont Addresses Continued

25 OLD COACH RD
235 PADDY HOLLOW RD
236 PADDY HOLLOW RD
243 PADDY HOLLOW RD
256 PADDY HOLLOW RD
268 PADDY HOLLOW RD
289 PADDY HOLLOW RD
405 PADDY HOLLOW RD
421 PADDY HOLLOW RD
422 PADDY HOLLOW RD
63 PIPER HILL RD
338 PLAINS RD
254 RED WATER BROOK RD
362 RED WATER BROOK RD
392 RED WATER BROOK RD
411 RED WATER BROOK RD
428 RED WATER BROOK RD
462 RED WATER BROOK RD
389 RIVER RD
184 ROBERTS HILL RD
41 SANDY LN

121 SPRINGFARM RD
79 STRAND RD
84 STRAND RD
105 STRAND RD
119 STRAND RD
130 STRAND RD
133 STRAND RD
407 SUGAR RIVER DR
436 SUGAR RIVER DR
457 SUGAR RIVER DR
14 SULLIVAN ST
746 WASHINGTON ST
822 WASHINGTON ST
875 WASHINGTON ST
917 WASHINGTON ST
919 WASHINGTON ST
49 WEBSTER AVE
40 WINDY HILL RD
62 WINDY HILL RD
66 WINDY HILL RD
68 WINDY HILL RD

70 WINDY HILL RD
86 WINDY HILL RD
88 WINDY HILL RD
106 WINDY HILL RD
128 WINDY HILL RD
196 WINTER ST
371 WINTER ST
657 WINTER ST

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Technology Lunch and Learn

Comcast provides:

- 15 Entry Level laptop computers - PC or Chromebook based
- 2-5 Volunteers who will help open and set-up computers with recipients
- Cybersecurity Presentation
- Information on Comcast's internet options
- Lunch!



Technology Lunch and Learn

Claremont provides:

- Organizer responsible for recipient coordination
- Venue with internet access and a presentation monitor, or projector and screen
- Identify 15 recipients



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Opioid Funding Update Presentation with TLC Family Resource Center

Dan Wargo, Program Manager from TLC Recovery Programs gave a brief overview and an annual update on the agency's recovery incentive initiatives that were launched in 2023 with the opioid litigation proceeds received by the City.



Litigation Funding: Addressing The Needs!

Community Needs

The need to build a stronger sense of community for those struggling with OUD



The need to increase participation retention during the first month of engagement



The need to give client's a stronger sense of direction when navigating through recovery



Litigation Contribution

Host regular events that support the concept of recovery community and give people a sense of belonging

Provide incentives that increase motivation for engagement during the first month

Launch and facilitate a new group specifically designed to help build a recovery plan of action

2024 Recovery-Based Events:

- February 3rd - Snow Ball Festival: 75 attendees
- March 15th - Shamrock Shenanigans: 45 attendees
- May 3rd - Cinco de Mayo Festival: 45 attendees
- August 16th - Summer Fun Mini Golf: 30 attendees
- August 17th - Summer Fun River Float: 20 attendees
- September 8th - 4th Annual Recovery Rally: 150 attendees
- September 27th - Light the Night Vigil: 60 attendees
- November 8th - Flannel Festival: 40 attendees
- December 6th - Ugly Sweater Party: 50 attendees
- February 21st, 2025 - Carnival Festival Fun: 45 attendees

Total Events: 11

Total Attendance: 560

Recovery Engagement Incentive (REI) Program:

Studies have shown that participants are most likely to disengage from recovery services within the first month, more so than at any other point. This is often due to relapse, a decline in motivation after initial enthusiasm, or not giving recovery supports enough time to demonstrate their effectiveness. To address this challenge and improve long-term recovery outcomes, we've introduced an incentive program designed to encourage continued engagement in individual recovery support.

- Total Participants: 133
- Graduates: 97
- 16% increase in engagements lasting over one month
- Significant increase in recovery capital averages
- December 2024: REI Program expanded to include recovery-based group attendance

Mapping Our Recovery Group:

This program is designed to provide a comprehensive approach to recovery, blending practical tools with essential peer-led support groups and recovery coaches. Drawing on TLC's expertise, we have identified the most effective strategies to engage participants, encourage self-reflection, foster active participation, and drive positive outcomes. These methods are proven to create lasting change and empower individuals throughout their recovery journey.

Over seven sessions, participants will develop a personalized recovery plan tailored to their unique needs and circumstances. Delivered in a group setting, the program includes educational activities and encourages the sharing of insights, enabling individuals to build a strong, sustainable recovery plan.

TLC has hosted this group 3 times with 31 graduates

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Fee Schedule

Mayor Girard opened the fee schedule.

Cemetery:

Councilor Koloski stated not being in favor of raising cemetery fees every year.

Councilor Hemingway questioned the reduction of winter fees, and stated taking away \$300.00 and only adding \$100.00 to internment doesn't seem right to him.

Assistant Mayor Matteau wants a resident cost and a non-resident cost.

Councilor Koloski asked if a portion of these fees can go towards records upkeep and retention.

The proposed Cemetery fee schedule did not pass.

FIRE:

Councilor Koloski questioned if the fees were enough cover full costs.

Mayor Girard asked if these new fees would be an annual fee or a one-time fee.

Chief Chamberlain explained it would be a one-time fee.

Assistant Mayor Matteau thinks these numbers are fair.

Councilor Hemingway called point of order, and asked if Councilor Koloski should be recusing himself.

Parks and Recreation:

Assistant Mayor Matteau noted concern for the last time Council raised the recreation fees that it might affect the memberships, and asked Director Martin if there was significant loss.

Director Martin noted when the fees were increased by 40%, he didn't think it affected the active memberships.

Councilor O'Hearne asked a hypothetical question, can you live without an increase in the fee schedule to Director Martin. Director Martin replied no, and stated even Active Entities suggested that the fees increase 2%-4% every year.

Councilor Hayden suggested to do a 2% increase for residents and a 4% increase for non-residents.

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Assistant Mayor Matteau understands the philosophy in doing small increases every year, and stated the fees are still underpriced. Assistant Mayor Matteau suggests a 3% on a regular basis is easier, and still a good value.

Councilor Limoges supports the 3% increase, and shared concern for the corporate membership.

Councilor Koloski stated he had a lot of concerns and would like to see the marketing update, and thinks there should be one set rate for resident and non-resident.

Mayor Girard stated being dead set against corporate, and that the center needs to be ran like a business, and noted the center has a spending issue. Revenues have come up but not enough, almost \$700,000.00 being paid by tax payers, and then stated when Council starts discussing budget he has a lot more to say.

The parks and Recreation proposed fee schedule changes did not pass.

Planning and Development:

City Planner Ford noted these changes were to cover more costs, not to align with surrounding towns, the costs of an abutter notice costs \$5.54.

Councilor Zutter asked why not cover it completely.

Assistant Mayor Matteau agrees to at least fully cover the cost.

Councilor Koloski suggested adding a covenant fee.

Building:

Building Inspector, Joel Tremblay noted the reason for these changes is the realization that bigger projects only have minimal permit fees. For example, there is a \$ 2.9 million project at a local grocery store and their permit fee will only be \$50, if the Council agrees to the changes the fee will be \$17,000.00. This will still be competitive, and will help bring more development into Claremont.

Manager Manale added the City is trying to find revenue that will help with the city's overall tax base.

Assistant Mayor Matteau stated there is an increase in building in the city, big projects are on the horizon, and thinks these are reasonable, and should increase.

Public Works:

Director Gleeson noted tire day was being taken advantage, so the only change is to limit the tires to four per household.

Police:

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There were no proposed changes for Police. Councilor Koloski questioned the rate for detail. Chief Wilmot noted its been this way since 2017, and Councilor Koloski wants this to be looked into.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Consensus from Council to Bring the Fee Schedule back at another meeting.

Resolution 2025-36 Baerbell Merrill Grant Acceptance

Chief Wilmot noted this was the second time to come to Council to request the acceptance of this donation.

A motion was made by Councilor Hemingway and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to accept Resolution 2025-36.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Zutter – yes

Hemingway – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Resolution 2025-37 Multi-Year Contract for Body Worn Camera Purchase Agreement

Chief Wilmot explained the federal grant that will help replace body worn cameras.

A motion was made by Councilor Koloski and seconded by Councilor Limoges to accept Resolution 2025-37.

Mayor Girard opened a public hearing, no one spoke. Mayor Girard closed the public hearing.

Roll call:

Koloski – yes

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Greenrose – yes
Limoges - yes
Matteau – yes
Zutter – yes
Hemingway – yes
Hayden – yes
O’Hearne – yes
Girard – yes
Motion carried 9-0

Budget Discussion

Manager Manale made note of the future budget discussions and their tentative dates.

Councilor Koloski wants to add a breakdown of funds for equipment.

Mayor Girard discussed the Community Center and had concerns about last year going up in expenses, and stated it needs to come down. Wants to see it at \$500,000.00.

Councilor Hemingway stated the CSBCC has been a burden and suggested privatizing it.

Mayor Girard stated he doesn’t think its a good idea to add positions to this budget.

Mayor Girard doesn’t think the City should be adding a Planning and Development Assistant Director Position.

Mayor Girard noted wanting to see marketing cut, and noted the City is not getting services like we once did from UVLSRC and to look at this.

Mayor Girard does not want to cut back on sidewalks and roads.

Mayor Girard said the state may be cutting their donation budget by 50%

Councilor Heminway agrees with a 50% cut to donations.

Assistant Mayor Matteau stated there are critical needs that help our community and is not in favor of cutting it.

Manager Manale noted it can be taken out and then funded from the unassigned fund balance.

Councilor Koloski wants the status of current contracts like the waste water facility, and Transfer Station.

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79-E Covenant Discussion

City Planner Austin Ford, and City Assessor, Steve Hamilton joined Council for the 79-E Discussion.

Mayor Girard would like to minimize number of years. Councilor Koloski wants to further define the term public benefit. City Planner, Ford noted public benefit is defined by an RSA.

Councilor Limoges thinks it should be more for market rate housing and not affordable housing.

Mayor Girard noted not putting a stipulation on housing.

Assistant Mayor Matteau noted this was a critical tool.

Councilor Koloski wants a legal opinion.

Assessor Hamilton, noted he will not give legal advice and stated when making narrowing determinations, the City can run the risk of boxing itself in.

Assistant Mayor Matteau asked if these applications were under a time constraint. City Planner, Ford replied yes. Assistant Mayor Matteau then suggested asking the applicant to give the Council an extension, and in meantime wants the City Manager to get a legal opinion.

Councilor Hayden stated the applicants should come to Council, its disrespectful and the Council should have these discussions in front of the applicants.

Councilor Zutter suggested we suspend the 79-E program until Council gets clarification if the applicants don't give Council an extension.

By Consensus the City Council agrees to meet earlier, at 5:30 p.m. on March 12th for a non-meeting with legal and to have Mr. Ford to ask the applicants to extend, and to invite City Planner Ford, and Assessor Hamilton to that conversation.

COMMITTEE REPORTS

Councilor Koloski reported for the Arts Commission that a board member removal may need to be discussed due to attendance. There will be an upcoming display at Visitors Center, and an establishment of an account to be brought to Council.

Assistant Mayor Matteau noted the Planning Committee discussed driveway regulations, St. Mary's Church did a minor sub division and was approved, amended a site plan for a four-unit on Broad St, and discussed the schedule for the Zoning sub-committee.

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Councilor Hemingway noted Policy will be looking into an ordinance regarding noise decibel levels.

Councilor Hayden noted the Conservation Commission is working on the Stevens brook trail.

Councilor O’Hearne stated the Tolles Home had a discussion on by laws.

FUTURE AGENDA ITEMS AND DIRECTIVES

Councilor Zutter wants a report through Parks and Recreation about the success with their collaboration with arrowhead.

CONSULTATION WITH LEGAL COUNSEL

None.

ADJOURNMENT

At 10:49 p.m., a motion was made by Assistant Mayor Matteau and seconded by Councilor O’Hearne to adjourn.

Voice vote:

Koloski – yes

Greenrose – yes

Limoges - yes

Matteau – yes

Hemingway – yes

Zutter – yes

Hayden – yes

O’Hearne – yes

Girard – yes

Motion carried 9-0

Respectfully Submitted,

Julia A. Bizzarro
Clerk to the Council